

As we mentioned earlier in this chapter, all the information you put on a disk is stored in files. The System Software itself is stored in a collection of files, and every program you use and every document you create is also stored in a file. The word “file” is a generic term for any collection of data. Let’s take a look at some of the files on your System Disk. Put your 3.5” System Disk in a drive and double-click it.

A window appears displaying the contents of the disk. The window, which can be moved, resized, and scrolled like any standard IIGS window, contains four icons—two folders called System and Icons, and two program files called ProDOS and BASIC.System. Just below the title bar is the info bar or the header—it tells you what kind of disk this window is from (ProDOS, in this case; other possibilities are HFS, DOS 3.3, Pascal, High Sierra, and AppleShare), how many files are in the window, how much space is used by the files on the disk, and how much space is left on the disk.

A disk’s icon and its window are intimately linked. In fact, in many ways, a disk’s icon and its window are *the same thing*. If you drag a file onto a disk’s icon, it appears in the disk’s window. You can also drag a file directly into a window to copy it to a disk. If you drag a file out of a disk’s window and onto the same disk’s icon, nothing happens, because you’ve told the Finder to move the file to where it already is.

The concept of each window being linked to a particular icon is an important one. (To find out which icon a given window is linked to, just click the white space inside the window. The corresponding disk icon will turn black. It’s now selected for any operation you care to perform on it—just as if you’d clicked the icon directly.)

The two folder icons represent, logically enough, folders—the two diamond-shaped icons with hands, which resemble sheets of paper being written on, are programs. (There’s an “8” written on the icons, indicating that they’re 8-bit programs.)

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Many programs have custom icons. If you see an icon you don’t recognize, it’s usually possible to make a guess. Icons with folded-down corners are usually documents; icons that resemble folders usually are; diamond-shaped icons are usually applications. When in doubt, use the “Icon Info” option on the Special menu to find out exactly what an icon represents.

Icons in a window can be colored, moved around, and renamed, just like icons on a desktop. (You can’t have two icons in a window with the same name, just as you can’t have two disks on the desktop with the same name.) The Finder remembers the colors you assign to icons in windows, as well as the positions of the icons within the window and the position (and size) of the window on the screen.